

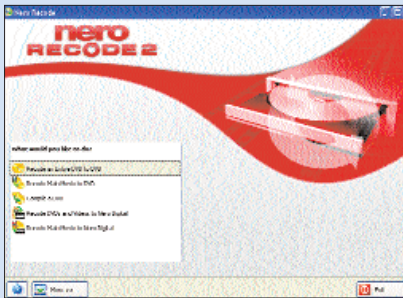


Master Nero Recode 2

Authoring your own DVD is easier than you think!

Jayesh Limaye

Burning a DVD or a CD today means using Nero—the simple user interface and powerful features have made it the *de facto* burning software. Most of us use Nero regularly, but in addition to the burning program, Nero bundles lots of useful goodies. One of these is Nero Recode 2.

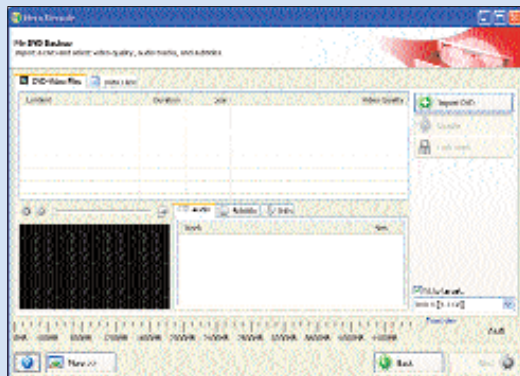


The Nero Recode 2 main window

Nero Recode 2 is a tool that can be used to copy, compile, and convert to and from DVDs that aren't copy-protected. You can launch it from Start > All Programs > Nero 7 Premium > Photo and Video > Nero Recode. In the main window, you will see five tasks:

- ☒ Recode an Entire DVD to DVD
- ☒ Recode Main Movie to DVD
- ☒ Remake a DVD
- ☒ Recode DVDs and Videos to Nero Digital
- ☒ Recode Main Movie to Nero Digital

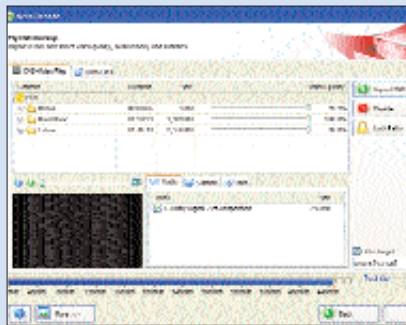
Click on "Recode an Entire DVD" to DVD to copy the entire DVD. The DVD-Video area of the backup window for your DVDs will now open.



Recoding an Entire DVD to DVD

Copying DVDs To DVDs

Click "Import DVD" to open the dialog to import the selected DVD or files onto the hard drive. You can use the Enable and Disable buttons to include or exclude parts of the title (such as extras) from the compilation. You can even enable or disable parts of the main movie or extras. In order to maintain the menu structure and compatibility of the recoded DVD, something else needs to take the place of the part that has been deleted. Use the drop-down to select the substitute—you can choose from among Custom Picture, Slide Show (where you can view a slide-show of stills from the deleted video) or Custom Color.



Recode an Entire DVD to DVD

Tweak The DVD Compilation

Click on "Lock Ratio" to stop the recording quality of a DVD title from being changed automatically. However, you can still change the quality manually by moving the slider. Click "Unlock Ratio" to let Recode automatically modify the video quality. The "Fit to Target" check box is checked by default—this means that the disc inserted will be automatically

recoded to fit the size of the blank disk inserted (where possible). If "Fit to Target" has been checked, you can select the target from the dropdown—the choices available are 8 cm DVD (1.4 GB), DVD-5 (4.7 GB), DVD-9 (8.5 GB), and Custom. The level indicator will be adjusted depending on the target. When the box is disabled, the size of a copy can be specified independently of the disc's size limitations.

Click on an item in the list and click on Play to preview the video. In the Audio area, you can select which audio track you want in the output—many DVDs have 2.1 as well as 5.1 channel sound tracks; some even have multiple-language audio tracks. Here you can choose the sound track of the format and language suitable for you. The Subtitles area works the same way. At the bottom of the page is the space indicator that lets you keep check on the size of the DVD. You should not allow the indicator to enter the red region.

Add Useful Data To The DVD

Click on "DVD Data Files" to move to the Nero Recode 2 data area. You can add data to the DVD here. Unlike the video area, you only have a window that shows the list of files. With "Recode Main Movie to DVD", you can import and recode the main movie of a personal, non-copy-protected DVD to another DVD, keeping the video quality intact. Here too, you can remove unwanted subtitles and audio tracks, and also trim the video.

Create Nero Digital a.k.a. MPEG-4 Content

"Recode DVDs and Videos to Nero Digital" allows you to convert content from one or several personal, non-copy-protected DVDs to Nero Digital or MPEG-4 files. The process is similar to creating a DVD video, with the difference that you can choose from among different Nero Digital categories such as Nero Digital, Nero Digital AVC, Sony Memory Stick Video, and Apple iPod. Under Nero Digital Profile, you can select Mobile, Portable, Standard, Cinema, and HDTV—their purpose is self-explanatory. You can also trim the video to remove unwanted portions. What's more, you can also create chapters by clicking on the Chapter button to give your DVD a more professional feel.

After you click on Next, you are provided with the option to either create the recoded files on the hard drive, burn to a CD/DVD-RW, or create an image file. You can also tweak the quality settings in Nero Digital Settings, but it's better to leave these alone unless you know exactly what you're doing. ■

jayesh_limaye@thinkdigit.com